Sarah Wheeler

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Education

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign Expected Graduation**:** May 2027
Bachelor of Science in Information Sciences + Data Science GPA: 4.0/4.0
Awards: James Scholar, Dean's List (6/6 semesters), P.E.O. Star Scholarship, 2026 Outstanding Undergraduate Poster Presentation Award

Professional Experience

84.51˚ (Kroger) **Cincinnati, OH**
Data Science & Research Intern *May 2026 – August 2026*
- Architected multi-agent AI system to consolidate dataset metadata from GitHub, Jira, and Confluence into a semantic layer for downstream AI, cutting per-dataset consolidation time by 64%
- Built an MLflow evaluation framework with 40+ programmatic checks and three LLM-as-a-judge scorers to detect agent failures and validate output quality before downstream use

ADM **Chicago, IL**
Data Analytics Intern, Investor Services *May 2025 – August 2025*
- Developed automated OFAC sanctions screening using layered fuzzy matching (Levenshtein, Jaro-Winkler), capturing 99.8% of true-positive matches to support regulatory compliance during customer onboarding
- Engineered two-layer futures price forecasting model (random forest + gradient-boosted residual correction), reducing mean absolute error by 71%

United States House of Representatives **Peoria, IL**
Congressional Intern *June 2023 – August 2023*
- Conducted legislative research on technology policy and presented findings to congressional staff and members

Leadership & Research

Break Through Tech **Remote**
Artificial Intelligence/Machine Learning Fellow *May 2026 – Present*
- Selected from a pool of 4,300+ applicants for a technical 12-month AI program with Cornell Tech
- Building a financial-resilience prediction system using Federal Reserve SHED microdata, comparing logistic regression, tree-based, and gradient-boosted models with probability calibration and SHAP-based explanations

Information Technology Ethics and Accessibility Lab **Remote**
Research Assistant *September 2025 – Present*
- Leading first-author survey study on desire for AI automation across daily-life domains, designing the instrument and a quantitative pipeline spanning correlation, predictive modeling, and clustering
- Co-authoring mixed-methods study of AI-assisted programming, combining LLM interaction logs and survey data to characterize over-reliance and human oversight in AI coding workflows

Adaptive Cognition & Interaction Design Lab **Champaign, IL**
Undergraduate Research Assistant *November 2024 – Present*
- Analyzing 60+ interview transcripts with computational linguistics (Coh-Metrix, NLTK) and thematic coding as co-author on a manuscript on health behavior change, goals, and barriers
- Presented first-author poster for a study on motivational-interviewing chatbot efficacy, contributing to the study's qualitative and statistical analysis and data visualization

Illinois Business Consulting **Champaign, IL**
Internal Operations Director *May 2025 – January 2026*
- Led internal project management and strategy across marketing, alumni, and media teams, coordinating organization-wide engagement for 300+ members

Alumni Operations & Engagement Coordinator *May 2024 – May 2025*
- Created and launched IBC's first structured alumni engagement strategy, introducing quarterly newsletters, annual alumni panels, and professional mentorship programs

Skills

Languages: Python, SQL, Java, R
Libraries & Frameworks: pandas, NumPy, scikit-learn, TensorFlow, NLTK
Tools & Platforms: Git, GitHub, Databricks, MLflow, Google ADK, Docker, Jupyter, Coh-Metrix
Data Science & AI: Agentic AI, Machine Learning, LLM Evaluation, Predictive Modeling, Data Visualization
Interests: Responsible AI, Human-Computer Interaction, AI Governance